

TEQUILA ACCELERATOR

Brand Selection Criteria — México–India Business Council

1 CERTIFICATION & REGULATORY COMPLIANCE

WHAT WE ASSESS

Legitimacy, authenticity & regulatory preparedness for Indian market entry

- ▶ CRT certified (tequila) with a valid NOM number; COMERCAM certified (mezcal) – Owned/Contracted to be disclosed.
- ▶ COFEPRIS sanitary/health certificate available per shipment batch
- ▶ Product documentation for FSSAI import clearance: Certificate of Analysis (CoA), ingredient declarations, product specifics sheet
- ▶ Bottle carries Guala cap (anti-refill security cap), for entering India's priority markets
- ▶ Label has physical space for MRP sticker + Indian importer address

2 PRODUCTION CAPACITY & SUPPLY RELIABILITY

WHAT WE ASSESS

Ability to fulfil the India market demand consistently over 12–24 months

- ▶ Annual production capacity: 15,000+ litres
- ▶ Production lead time: 4–8 weeks for reorders (manufacturing only)
- ▶ Minimum first shipment requirement: 1 FCL (20-ft container ≈ 1,100–1,200 cases of 750ml)
- ▶ Total order-to-warehouse lead time is 8–14 weeks: 4–8 weeks production + 25–35 days sea transit + 7–15 days Indian customs clearance

3 EXPORT EXPERIENCE & OPERATIONAL MATURITY

WHAT WE ASSESS

Track record in international markets and operational sophistication

- ▶ Currently exports to at least 1 international market
- ▶ Understanding of basic export documentation, logistics, and compliance & established personnel to handle Mexican export customs declaration
- ▶ Operationally equipped with banking services to receive foreign transfers

4 PRICING COMPETITIVENESS & MARGIN VIABILITY

WHAT WE ASSESS

Whether FOB price can absorb India's full duty cascade and remain competitive

- ▶ Has verified FOB-TO-MRP Benchmarks
- ▶ Target retail price competitive within category positioning
- ▶ Complete India duty cascade: BCD 150% + Social Welfare Surcharge 10% of BCD + IGST 18% on (CIF+BCD+SWS) + state excise 30–100%+ = effective landed cost 4–6× CIF price

5 FINANCIAL CAPACITY & COMMITMENT

WHAT WE ASSESS

Ability to fund market entry and sustain investment during ramp-up

- ▶ Can invest USD 75,000–150,000 (Estimated) in Year 1 (shipment, samples, marketing, compliance)
- ▶ Budget 50+ bottles per SKU as pre-commercial samples
- ▶ Can operate on 60–90-day payment cycles
- ▶ Currency risk awareness, as USD/INR fluctuation directly impacts landed cost and distributor margin

6 BRAND READINESS & LEADERSHIP ENGAGEMENT

WHAT WE ASSESS

Marketing assets, decision-making capability & founder commitment

- ▶ Has product photography, brand deck, tasting notes with active Digital Presence
- ▶ Clear brand story and differentiation narrative, all brand materials available in English
- ▶ Management directly involved in India strategy; can travel or participate virtually
- ▶ Bartender training kit ready (or willing to develop)

ELIGIBILITY THRESHOLD

Brands **MUST qualify** in **Criterion 1 (Certification & Compliance)** and **Criterion 5 (Financial Capacity)**. These are non-negotiable prerequisites. Brands must also meet minimum requirements in at least **4 out of 6 criteria** to be eligible for the Tequila Accelerator Program.

Terms used: *Basic Customs Duty (BCD) *Social Welfare Surcharge (SWS) *IGST (Integrated Goods & Services Tax) *CIF (Cost Insurance Freight)